

UI Specification Document

Project: Personalized Trip Planner

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General Overview:

This web application is a personalized travel recommendation engine designed to simplify trip planning. Users provide specific inputs such as their budget, trip duration, and the number of travelers. The system processes this data on the server side to filter and return the most suitable travel destinations and itineraries from the database.

The platform also fosters a community feel by allowing users to discuss trips in a dedicated forum.

This travel website includes eight main pages:

Page	Purpose
Home Page (/index)	Introduces the website and leads the user to start planning.
Login Page (/login)	Allows users to enter their account and access the website.
Signup Page (/signup)	Allows new users to complete their registration by providing additional personal details.
Trip Preferences Page (/preferences)	A form where users answer questions about their travel needs and preferences, such as trip type, budget, number of travelers, and other details that help the website plan a suitable trip.
Recommendations Page (/recommendations)	Displays a curated list of travel options that match the user's specific criteria, generated after server-side processing.
Trip Details Page (/trip-details)	Presents a specific destination in detail, including location, images, description, and users' recommendations.
My Trips (/my-trips)	A centralized gallery displaying all trips generated by the user to date, allowing them to revisit past itineraries, view saved trips, and track their travel history.
Forgot Password Page (/forgot-password)	Shows that password recovery is not available and links back to login.

Home Page

Purpose

The Home page introduces the Personalized Trip Planner and explains the main idea of the website. It guides users toward starting the trip planning process.

Components

• Header with logo and navigation links	• How It Works section
• Main hero section	• Travel style cards
• Product title and short description	• Footer with contact information
• Start Planning button	

Logic and Behavior

The Home page is available to all users. It does not require login. The main action on this page sends the user to the Plan a Trip page.

Plan a Trip Page

Purpose

The Plan a Trip page collects the user's travel preferences. This page is the main place where users choose the information used to generate recommendations.

Components

• Header with navigation	• Interests checkboxes
• Page introduction	• Kosher-friendly checkbox
• Trip type dropdown	• Generate Recommendations button
• Budget input	• Field validation messages
• Duration input	• General form feedback message
• Number of travelers input	• Footer with contact information

Logic and Behavior

The form validates the required fields before submission. Trip type, budget, duration, and number of travelers are required. Interests are optional. When the form is submitted successfully, the selected preferences are saved in sessionStorage. If the user returns to this page during the same browser session, the form is filled with the previously selected values. After successful submission, the user is redirected to the Recommendations page.

Guest vs Logged-in Behavior

Guests and logged-in users can both use this page in the same way. Login is not required for planning a trip or generating recommendations.

Recommendations Page

Purpose

The Recommendations page displays trip packages that match the preferences selected by the user on the Plan a Trip page.

Components

• Header with navigation	• Trip cards with image and details
• Recommendations hero section	• View Details button
• Results status message	• Save Trip button
• Update Preferences button	• Guest save modal
• Recommendation cards grid	• Footer with contact information

Logic and Behavior

The Recommendations page reads the saved trip preferences from sessionStorage. The page does not include a second filter sidebar because filtering is handled on the Plan a Trip page.

The recommendation logic checks the selected trip type, budget, and duration. Trip type must match the selected trip type. Budget allows trips up to twenty percent above the user's budget. Duration allows trips within three days above or below the selected duration. Interests are optional and help improve the ranking of matching trips. Ratings also affect ranking and are calculated from real review data.

The page shows the best matching trips first and limits the number of displayed results. If no saved preferences exist, the page guides the user back to Plan a Trip. If no trips match the required rules, a clear message is shown.

Guest vs Logged-in Behavior

Guests can view recommendations and open trip details. If a guest tries to save a trip, a login or signup modal appears. Logged-in users can save trips directly, and saved trips are added to My Trips.

Trip Details Page

Purpose

The Trip Details page displays full information about a selected trip package. It helps users inspect the trip before saving it or leaving a review.

Components

• Header with navigation	• Tags and Interests section
• Trip hero section	• Traveler Reviews section
• Trip title and location	• Leave a Review form
• Main trip image	• Essential Info sidebar
• Save Trip button	• Calculated rating summary
• Visual Gallery section	• Guest save modal
• Day-by-Day Itinerary section	• Footer with contact information

Logic and Behavior

The page loads the correct trip based on the trip id in the page URL. Trip information is rendered dynamically from local trip data.

The rating shown on the page is calculated from real review data. It includes static reviews from the trip data and user-submitted reviews from localStorage. Only reviews with numeric ratings are counted. When a new review is submitted, the review list, average rating, and review count update immediately.

The review form validates that a rating and review text were entered. Reviews are stored in localStorage. Each logged-in user can submit only one review per trip. Duplicate reviews from the same user for the same trip are blocked.

Guest vs Logged-in Behavior

Guests can view trip details and read reviews. Guests cannot submit reviews. If a guest tries to leave a review, the page shows a message asking the user to log in or sign up. If a guest tries to save a trip, a login or signup modal appears.

Logged-in users can save trips and submit one review per trip. After submitting a review, the user cannot submit another review for the same trip. The user's own review is shown with a friendly label instead of exposing the email address.

My Trips Page

Purpose

The My Trips page displays trips saved by the logged-in user. It acts as the user's personal saved trips area.

Components

• Header with navigation	• View Details button
• Page title and description	• Remove Trip button
• Saved trip cards	• Empty state message
• Trip image	• Guest login/signup prompt
• Trip title and location	• Footer with contact information
• Trip metadata	

Logic and Behavior

Saved trips are stored in localStorage. Each saved trip is stored with a timestamp, so the newest saved trips appear first. Users can remove saved trips. Before removing a trip, the page asks for confirmation. If no trips are saved, an empty state message is displayed.

Guest vs Logged-in Behavior

Guests cannot view a personal saved trips list. Instead, they see a message encouraging them to log in, sign up, or start planning. Logged-in users can view saved trips, open trip details, and remove trips from My Trips.

Login Page

Purpose

The Login page allows users to enter the frontend-only logged-in state.

Components

• Header with navigation	• Login button
• Login form	• Link to Signup page
• Email input	• Validation messages
• Password input	• Footer with contact information
• Forgot Password link	

Logic and Behavior

The login form validates that the email field is filled, that the email format is valid, and that the password field is filled. Password minimum length is not required on login. After successful validation, the current user is saved in localStorage and the user is redirected to My Trips.

Guest vs Logged-in Behavior

Guests can use the login form. After login, the user can save trips, view My Trips, and submit reviews. Logged-in state is simulated on the frontend and does not use a backend.

Signup Page

Purpose

The Signup page allows users to create a frontend-only account state. This lets them save trips and submit reviews.

Components

• Header with navigation	• Password input
• Signup form	• Confirm password input
• First name input	• Complete Registration button
• Last name input	• Validation messages
• Email input	• Footer with contact information

Logic and Behavior

The signup form validates first name, last name, email, password, and password confirmation. Email must use a valid format. Password and confirmation must match. If password strength or minimum length validation exists, it remains active. After successful signup, the user is saved in localStorage and redirected to the Plan a Trip page.

Guest vs Logged-in Behavior

Guests can create an account state through this page. After signup, the user is treated as logged in. Logged-in users can save trips, view My Trips, and submit reviews.

Forgot Password Page

Purpose

The Forgot Password page informs users that password recovery is not available in the current frontend-only version of the project.

Components

• Header with navigation	• Back to Login button
• Main password recovery message	• Footer with contact information

Logic and Behavior

The page is static. It does not send an email, reset a password, or connect to a backend service. It only displays the password recovery unavailable message.

Guest vs Logged-in Behavior

Guests and logged-in users see the same message. No password recovery action is available.

UI Behavior Specifications

Navigation Behavior: The header appears across the project and gives users access to the main pages. The logo links back to the Home page. Navigation paths are adjusted according to whether the page is at the root level or inside the pages folder. The navigation does not use an active page state.

Planning Behavior: The Plan a Trip form is the single place where users choose trip preferences. The form validates required fields before saving data. Preferences are stored in sessionStorage and are used by the Recommendations page. Returning to the form during the same session restores the previous values.

Recommendation Behavior: Recommendations are generated from saved preferences. The page checks trip type, budget, and duration as required matching rules. Interests are optional and improve ranking when they match. Ratings used for display and ranking are calculated from real review data.

Save Trip Behavior: Saving trips requires a logged-in user. Guests who try to save a trip see a login or signup modal. Logged-in users can save trips from Recommendations or Trip Details. Saved trips are stored in localStorage and appear in My Trips.

Review Behavior: Reviews can only be submitted by logged-in users. Guests can read reviews but cannot submit them. Each logged-in user can submit only one review per trip. Reviews are stored in localStorage and update the review list, average rating, and review count.

Rating Behavior: Ratings are calculated from reviews with numeric ratings. The calculation uses both static reviews from the trip data and user-submitted reviews stored in localStorage. The displayed rating and review count are shared between Trip Details and Recommendations.

My Trips Behavior: My Trips is available for logged-in users. Saved trips are displayed newest first. Removing a trip requires confirmation. Guests see a message that guides them to log in, sign up, or start planning.

Authentication Behavior: Login and signup are simulated on the frontend using localStorage. No real backend authentication is used. The logged-in state allows saving trips, viewing My Trips, and submitting reviews. Passwords are not sent to a server.

Password Recovery Behavior: The Forgot Password link navigates to a static page. The page explains that password recovery is not available. No recovery process is performed.

Visual Design Notes

General Style

The visual style is clean, calm, and travel-focused. The interface uses soft backgrounds, cards, clear spacing, and trip images. The design should feel like a small travel planning product.

Colors

The main colors are blue, green, white, and soft neutral tones. Blue is used for main actions and links. Green is used for highlights, success feedback, and section labels. Neutral backgrounds help the trip images and cards stand out.

Typography

The project uses a simple Arial and Helvetica font stack. Hero headings are larger and more prominent. Card headings and form headings are smaller so the content remains easy to scan.

Cards

Cards are used throughout the project for trip packages, saved trips, travel styles, itinerary items, and reviews. Cards should present information in a clear order, with enough spacing between text, metadata, and actions.

Forms

Forms should be clear and easy to complete. Labels should be visible. Required fields should be marked. Validation messages should appear close to the related fields. Form feedback should be short and understandable.

Buttons

Primary buttons are used for main actions. Secondary buttons are used for supporting actions. Save buttons use heart wording. Buttons should remain consistent across pages and should not overflow on small screens.

Images

Trip images are important to the visual identity of the project. Images should be clear, relevant, and responsive. Trip cards and Trip Details should use images to help users understand the destination or travel style.

Responsive Design

The layout should work on desktop, tablet, and mobile. On desktop, grids can show multiple cards per row. On mobile, forms and cards should stack vertically. The navigation should collapse into a mobile menu. Trip Details content and sidebar should stack on smaller screens.

Feedback States

The interface should show clear feedback for important actions. Success messages should confirm completed actions. Error messages should explain what needs to be fixed. Empty states should guide the user toward the next useful action.

Animation

Animations should be subtle. Card hover movement, button hover movement, image zoom, and fade-in effects are acceptable. Animations should support the interface without distracting from the content.